

Printable solar materials are one of the examples that could turn parts of a house into solar panels. Quantum dots are set to revolutionise the field of displays, improving resolution and colour contrast. Nanosensors for agricultural pest management are already on their way to the market.

Virtual assistants

Personal digital assistants like Amazon Alexa are already present in the market, and many more will be released this year.

An automated grocery store is a good example of virtual assistants being deployed on a large scale. This is eliminating the need for cashiers. Watasale, India's first cashier-less store in Kochi, Kerala, is a major tech triumph of 2018.

Virtual assistants allow users to control anything through voice commands, and perform services or tasks on their behalf. These exploit AI, NLP, ML, voice processing, and reasoning and knowledge representation to

make human-machine interactions simpler, more natural and appealing.

Chatbots are shaping the business growth story. By 2020, it would reach its full market potential, with majority of businesses employing chatbots to redefine their customer engagement policies with the integration of NLP.

AR and VR

AR and VR will revolutionise the construction industry and change the way buildings are made. This will help with planning and plotting sites before even breaking ground.

AR tools help healthcare workers save lives. AR and VR will be used extensively in training and guiding doctors and the military.

VR has revolutionised the gaming industry, too.

AR is playing a vital role in Industry 4.0. It helps select manufacturing parts and send industrial fault status information to applications installed on users' phones and assemblies. Many companies are developing

applications to provide real-time information about product processing to workers. They are also making smart applications that help with decision-making and improved work procedures.

To sum up

The technology today has world-changing potential in the near future. By 2020, the human face will become the ideal technology partner, from unlocking a phone, house or car, to withdrawing money from a bank ATM.

Apart from giving data related to how users would react, technology will also guide businesses on how they should act when users behave in a certain way. Hence, companies will be investing more in educating and training workforces for the coming digital era.

Several technological revolutions will come and go. What is important is to stay updated with all the latest developments and to understand how these will affect the world. **EFY**

www.opensourceforu.com

Open Source Is **Hot** In The IT World

Hadoop, Apache, Android, MySQL, PostgreSQL, OSS, OpenStack, Joomla, Drupal, PHP

EFY GROUP PUBLICATIONS

THE COMPLETE MAGAZINE ON OPEN SOURCE



- >> To find dealers to buy copy from news-stand, visit: www.ezine.lfyimag.com
- >> To subscribe, visit: pay.efyindia.com
- >> To buy an ezine edition, visit: www.magzter.com choose Open Source For You